01 / READING SALON

Let the text hold the conversation open.

This fictional salon explores how a short passage can support more than one reading. Its purpose is to make attention and interpretation discussable, not to arrive at an authorised emotional response.

Three original passages support three rounds: first response, closer reading and comparison. No published work, external author statement or actual group of readers is represented. Participation can include a private response or a pass on sharing.

Reading intention

Keep the wording available while discussing it. A confident interpretation should remain open to a different reading grounded in the same passage.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Material	Three original passages written for this fictional exercise.
Rounds	First response, closer reading and comparison.
Boundary	No published-text attribution or real reader response.

What can the text support, and what are you adding to it?

READING CELL

P01 / first-response

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

02 / READING SALON

Read passage A as an authored miniature.

Passage A, The Place at the Table, offers an ordinary room and a small change in expectation. Read the wording before deciding what happened outside it.

The light moved across the table. Mira left a cup beside a folded letter. When she returned, the room looked unchanged, but the place she intended to sit no longer felt like hers.

Material note / passage A

This is original exercise text, not a quotation from an actual publication. The passage supplies no explanation of the letter, another person or the reason for Mira’s feeling.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Visible detail	Light, cup, letter and an intended place.
Interpretive gap	The reason for the changed feeling is unstated.
Source status	Original authored exercise passage, not an external citation.

Which word or image shapes your first impression?

READING CELL

P01 / closer-reading

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

03 / READING SALON

Agree how to discuss uncertainty.

Distinguish the words on the page from the story you imagine around them. A reader can offer a tentative interpretation without presenting it as the author’s intention.

Ask permission before turning another person’s response into a named note or later quotation. A participant can decline a personal association. This template establishes no actual recording agreement or confidentiality guarantee.

Reading agreement / passage B

At the fork, the sign named two places but pointed to neither. I stayed beside it until the footsteps behind me faded. Then the silence seemed less like an answer than another direction. This is original exercise text.

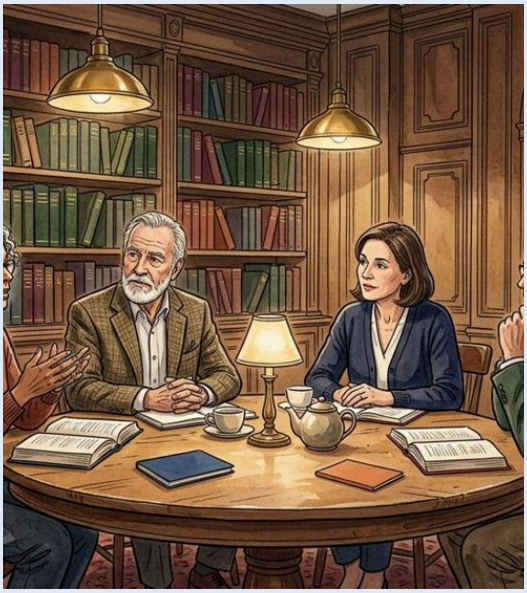


Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Text evidence	Point to the wording before explaining an inference.
Interpretation	Use tentative language and leave room for alternatives.
Choice	Personal disclosure, naming and quotation are not required.

How can another reader disagree without being asked to defend a private experience?

READING CELL

P01 / comparison

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

04 / READING SALON

Round one: notice before explaining.

Invite a first response to a sound, object or contrast in the passage. A useful opening can be a detail rather than a complete interpretation.

The box held a key, a ribbon and a label from an empty drawer. I kept them together, not because they were valuable, but because each changed what the others seemed to mean. This is passage C, an original exercise text.

First-response round

Ask which detail stayed with the reader. Do not turn several mentions of an image into a measure of the group’s opinion or an indication of the correct reading.

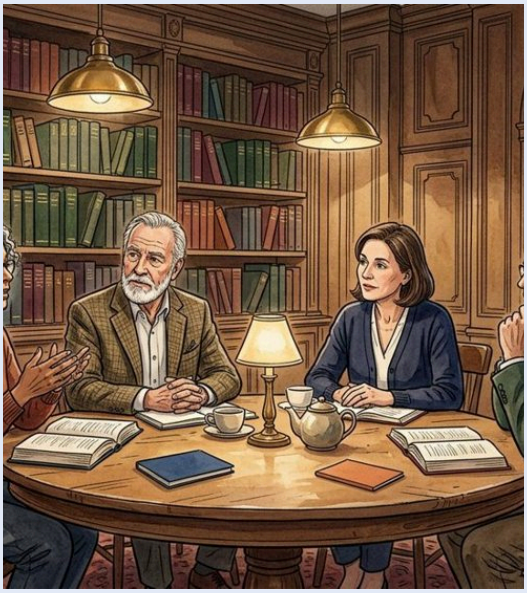


Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Notice	Choose a word, object or contrast.
Hold open	Do not require a full explanation at this stage.
Recording boundary	No actual responses or group preferences supplied.

Which detail can you name before deciding what it represents?

READING CELL

P02 / first-response

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

05 / READING SALON

Round two: inspect the wording.

Return to passage A and compare looked unchanged with no longer felt like hers. The two phrases distinguish an outward description from an experienced change.

Ask what that contrast permits a reader to infer and what it leaves unresolved. The passage does not establish a lost relationship, a conflict or a biographical fact. A possible reading is not a fact about an external author.

Closer-reading round

Use the exact relevant wording in an appropriately agreed note. Keep the explanation beside the phrase so another reader can inspect the connection.

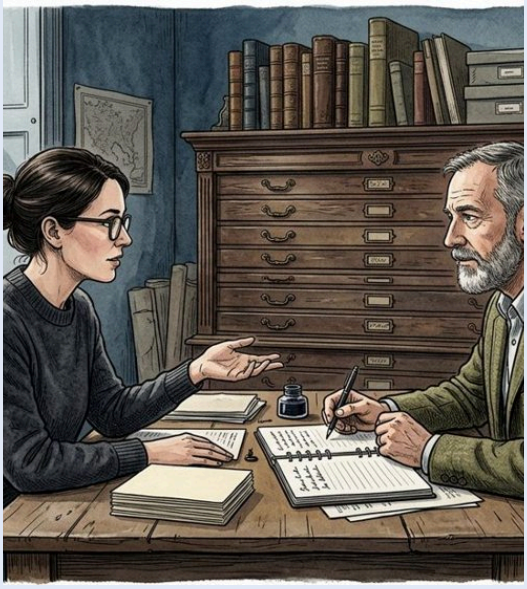


Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Phrase one	The room looked unchanged.
Phrase two	The place no longer felt like hers.
Question	Which part of the meaning is supplied by the contrast?

What can this contrast support without an invented backstory?

READING CELL

P02 / closer-reading

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

06 / READING SALON

Round three: compare plausible readings.

One reading of passage B might emphasise indecision; another might emphasise a chosen pause. Both need to explain how they use the sign, the fading footsteps and the final silence.

Comparison is not a vote on which reader is correct. Ask what each reading notices and what it has to assume. The exercise provides no actual discussion or recorded disagreement.

Comparison round

Keep more than one interpretation when the wording permits it. Do not attach a claim about the author’s life or intention without an appropriate real source.

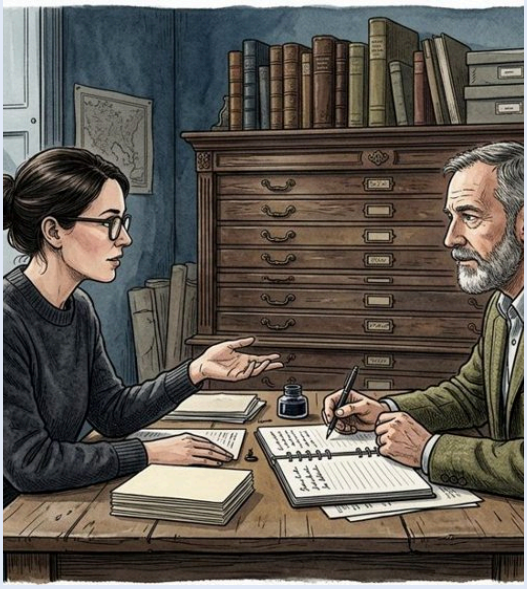


Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Reading route	A pause may be indecision, attention or another possibility.
Text anchor	Sign, footsteps and silence remain inspectable details.
Boundary	No actual group consensus or author-intent evidence.

Which reading requires an assumption the passage does not supply?

READING CELL

P02 / comparison

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

07 / READING SALON

Use associations without requiring disclosure.

A passage may suggest another object, situation or imagined scene. A participant can discuss that association as a reading move without explaining a personal experience.

Keep the return path to the text visible. An association can open a question but does not prove what the passage means. If someone chooses not to share, the discussion can continue with the supplied fictional material.

Context and association

The salon guide supplies no counselling or specialist support role. Do not use the exercise to elicit private material beyond the agreed reading purpose.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Association	An optional imagined context or comparison.
Return to text	Identify which detail prompted the association.
Participation boundary	No personal history or emotional disclosure required.

How does this association change what you notice in the wording?

READING CELL

P03 / first-response

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

08 / READING SALON

Build a shared record that preserves alternatives.

A useful record names the passage, the round, the relevant phrase and a tentative reading. Retain an open question or contrasting interpretation beside it.

The source register contains nine unrecorded discussion cells: three passages across three rounds. Empty cells do not mean that no one engaged. No actual reader words, permissions or attendance are supplied.

Shared reading record

Distinguish a reader’s exact words from an organiser’s paraphrase. Agree any actual use of names and later sharing before retaining the record.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Index	Passage ID and discussion round.
Content	A phrase, tentative interpretation and open question.
Evidence status	9 unrecorded cells; not 9 observed responses.

Can another reader see the wording that supports each interpretation?

READING CELL

P03 / closer-reading

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

09 / READING SALON

Extend the reading without inventing a bibliography.

An extension can return to a sentence with a different question, place two of the authored passages together or write a new miniature that changes one contextual detail.

This guide supplies no external reading list, publication details or claims that a real writer influenced the passages. If actual works are added, verify attribution, permitted use and relevant source information.

Further reading as a task

Compare the table in passage A with the box in passage C: both organise a relationship among ordinary things. That comparison is an editorial prompt, not an established interpretation.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Return	Re-read one sentence with a different question.
Compare	Consider an object or contrast across two supplied passages.
Source check	Verify any actual external work before adding it.

What new question becomes visible when two passages are read together?

READING CELL

P03 / comparison

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.

10 / READING SALON

Review how the conversation used the text.

After an actual salon, ask whether readers could point to wording, whether alternative interpretations remained visible and whether people understood that sharing was optional.

The current guide records no attendance, satisfaction, discussion result or change in reading ability. Its closing page is a review method, not a report of a completed event. Retain source and permission boundaries when adapting it.

Salon reflection

Carry forward one question that deserves another reading and one change to the discussion format. A shared record need not end with agreement.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

PASSAGE / PHRASE / INTERPRETATION

Text review	Could interpretations be connected to visible wording?
Format review	Was there room for a pause, pass or alternative reading?
Outcome boundary	No actual event or measured reader outcome supplied.

Which uncertainty would make a worthwhile starting point next time?

READING CELL

P01 / first-response

TEXT / RESPONSE BOUNDARY

3 original passages × 3 rounds; 9 unrecorded cells, not reader responses.